Modelling Moon Phases · Tier Pack · Supported

Learning goal: I can test a 3D model of the Moon's orbit to record all eight phases and evaluate the model.

Supported Route (Book First)

Match the 8 phase pictures to Positions 1 to 8 on your sheet and label New Moon, First Quarter, Full Moon, and Third Quarter.

Help: Pos 1 = all dark (New Moon). Pos 3 = right half lit (First Quarter). Pos 5 = all lit (Full Moon). Pos 7 = left half lit (Third Quarter).

Optional Make It · Supported

Build the 8-Phase Picture Ring

Place the 8 shaded Moon phase cards onto Positions 1 to 8 on your orbit mat and copy the four main phases into your book.

Word Help

waxing crescent: the phase after New Moon when a thin sliver of light grows on the right

waxing gibbous: the phase before Full Moon when more than half of the face is lit and growing

waning gibbous: the phase after Full Moon when more than half is lit and shrinking

waning crescent: the final thin sliver of light before the cycle returns to New Moon

Exit Check

In our model, what did the torch, the observer, and the ball represent?